

SOP-FIREP-3000: Portable Fire Extinguisher Inspection and Maintenance

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Section 1. Purpose and Scope

Governs inspection, maintenance, and hydrostatic testing of portable fire extinguishers.

Section 2. Monthly Visual Inspection

Clause 2.1 — Every extinguisher is visually inspected monthly: gauge in the operable range, pin and tamper seal intact, no visible damage or corrosion, and unobstructed access. Inspection is logged on the extinguisher's tag with initials and date.

Section 3. Annual Maintenance

Clause 3.1 — A full annual maintenance inspection by a qualified technician is required in addition to monthly visual checks, including internal examination per the extinguisher type's maintenance schedule.

Section 4. Hydrostatic Testing

Clause 4.1 — Hydrostatic testing interval is per the extinguisher type: 5 years for most dry-chemical and water types, 12 years for dry-chemical stored-pressure types with a stainless shell, per the manufacturer's specification. An extinguisher past its hydrostatic test due date shall be removed from service immediately.

Section 5. Out-of-Service Handling

Clause 5.1 — An extinguisher removed from service (discharge, damage, failed inspection) shall be immediately replaced with a fully charged unit of at least equivalent rating at that location — a fire protection gap is not left pending replacement scheduling.

Section 6. Records

Clause 6.1 — Monthly inspection tags, annual maintenance records, and hydrostatic test certificates are filed to the Fire Protection File and retained for the life of the extinguisher.